THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapters 9–12: **The Boy Who Broke the Bank, The Visitor (from The Book Thief), Helen Keller (poem) - Langston Hughes, The Stolen Bacillus** | Class 8 English_Gulmohar | Maximum Marks: 50

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 15 × 1 = 15

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(b)** gently mocking	The reader sees his error and smiles.
2	**(c)** Liesel's inner thoughts	Italic lines are her thoughts.
3	**(b)** inner insight can outshine physical sight	A paradox of sight and blindness.
4	**(a)** briefly let his true feeling show	The gleam is gone at once, hiding his intent.
5	**(a)** focus on the action rather than the unnamed throwers	The throwers are an anonymous mob.
6	**(a)** firmness was needed to stop the panic	He needed obedience in a crisis.
7	**(a)** carry the sentence smoothly across lines	The sentence runs on.
8	**(a)** his panic and his absent-minded character	Details underline his haste.
9	**(c)** We walked along the river bank.	River bank is a different noun.
10	**(a)** close in meaning, both describing a bent, drawn-up posture	Both indicate a low bent body.
11	**(b)** emotional and respectful	Positive emotion.
12	**(c)** the body is harmless and the 'infection' is imaginary	The Anarchist is not infected by cholera.
13	**(c)** preferred his suspicion to the plain fact	A rumour-minded mind rejects simple truth.
14	**(a)** metaphor for difficulty in breathing	Direct comparison without 'like'.
15	**(d)** the one in the dark finds more light than those who see	Blindness yields a brighter inner light.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 5 × 2 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
16	It links scenes into a chain (1) and builds the sense of a growing, uncontrolled rumour (1).	1+1
17	A light event, the new ball, sits beside a threat (1). This contrast hints that danger hides in ordinary life (1).	1+1
18	A person in darkness finds light (1); this shows that inner insight can exceed physical sight (1).	1+1
19	Sealed tubes and microscopes suggest hidden danger (1). The cosy talk contrasts with the deadly subject (1).	1+1
20	The clerk and manager state calm facts (1) while the crowd runs on imagination (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 5 × 3 = 15

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
21	The words 'pay' and 'bank' recur (1). 'Two months' grows to 'three months' and 'short of money' to 'bankrupt' (1). Escalation creates humour and shows distortion (1).	1+1+1
22	Football and a hidden refugee (1). A cheerful officer and a threatened family (1). The contrast produces tension and irony (1).	1+1+1
23	Verb 'found' makes it an achievement (1). It is discovered through the soul's mastery (1). So it is earned by effort, not given (1).	1+1+1
24	His questions about 'the living state' show interest (1). The remark on Anarchists being fools reveals his mind (1). His cut-off 'I think—' hints at an idea in progress (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Idiom and simile make the story vivid (1). They give the rumour animal-like energy (1). They add to humour (1).	1+1+1
25	They give the scene sharp, precise images (1). They show the physical and mental confusion (1). They make the language vivid for young readers (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Many have eyes but not insight (1). She lacked sight but had insight (1). True perception is of the mind and spirit (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers

2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
26	(a) Simile (1). (b) It shows speed and lack of control (1). (c) The list of shops shows the news reaching everyone (1). (d) Circulated means spread among many people (1). (e) The town is small, close and gossipy (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Plot: plan, knock, inspection, relief (1). Setting and secret increase danger (1). Short sentences, italics and headings build tension (1). Characters act in character (1). Overall: gripping and humane (1).	2+2+1
27	Theme: inner power (1). Imagery: dark and light (1). Form: three short stanzas, simple words (1). Tone: admiring (1). Message: look beyond appearance and limits (1).	2+2+1
	OR: The Anarchist's grand plan (1). The harmless culture (1). Scientist's own rhetoric and scare (1). Comic chase (1). The message that unreasoned zeal looks foolish (1).	2+2+1

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapters 9–12: **The Boy Who Broke the Bank, The Visitor (from The Book Thief), Helen Keller (poem) - Langston Hughes, The Stolen Bacillus** | Class 8 English_Gulmohar | Maximum Marks: 50

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 15 × 1 = 15

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(d)** sound casual about the bacteria	He hides his real interest.
2	**(d)** the chain of whispered news moving closer to the bank	The reader waits to see where it ends.
3	**(c)** the listening party man, as a performance	He is acting normal for the officer's ears.
4	**(d)** 'She' from the previous line carries over	Stanza-opening 'She'.
5	**(a)** blames his profession for his strange behaviour	She has put up with his oddity before.
6	**(a)** the run on the bank would have been avoided	Trust would have been restored.
7	**(b)** clear-headed	Perplexed means confused.
8	**(c)** dark and light	Core imagery.
9	**(d)** the Bacteriologist, in dialogue	He explains the matter to Minnie.
10	**(c)** It adds to the suspicion that the bank is hiding something	People see it as proof the bank was refusing payment.
11	**(b)** personification	Heartbeats are said to fight.
12	**(c)** a blind person brings light to a seeing world	Darkness and light together.
13	**(a)** the stolen tube drives the entire plot	The theft starts the chase.
14	**(b)** light, humorous and gently satirical	Comic irony runs through.
15	**(a)** relieved yet uneasy because the danger was close	Relief with lingering unease.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 5 × 2 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
16	Offering hospitality is what a relaxed, innocent host would do (1). It helps the family seem to have nothing to hide (1).	1+1
17	It values a disabled woman's contribution (1) and urges equal respect regardless of physical limits (1).	1+1
18	He is paid to speed up (1) and so unknowingly helps the plot's tension and comedy (1).	1+1
19	A raised, angry voice at 'Goondas! Hooligans!' (1) and a tired, bitter tone at 'increase of work' (1).	1+1
20	The Nazi officer acts kindly (1). Yet he serves a cruel regime, showing that systems can corrupt (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 5 × 3 = 15

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
21	He fears a stolen tube of germs in a stranger's hands (1). The tube proves harmless, so the hurry was needless (1). The reader sees the contrast between his panic and the truth (1).	1+1+1
22	News is checked fact (1). A rumour is unverified talk (1). The bank's 'collapse' was a rumour, though people treated it as news (1).	1+1+1
23	As soon as the officer left, Rosa melted by the stove (1). It shows quick relief (1). The clause of time is subordinate (1).	1+1+1
24	Found: verb (1). Loveliness: noun (1). Brighter: adjective (comparative) (1).	1+1+1
	OR: The narrator can move between minds (1). We see the Bacteriologist's, Minnie's and the Anarchist's views (1). This makes the irony clear (1).	1+1+1
25	Everyone knows everyone (1). News travels fast in a small town (1). With few crises, any event looks serious (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Direct remarks like 'You don't usually imagine' (1). This invites the reader to share the experience (1). It heightens suspense and sympathy (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers

2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
26	Format (1). Surprise at the rumours (1). Explain his holiday and the bank's real position (1). Request them to trust facts and not gossip (1). Courteous closing (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Date and tone (1). Mention football girl and her injury (1). Mention the family's welcome and the basement (1). Show his ordinary, unaware outlook (1). End with a casual closing (1).	2+2+1
27	Society may judge disabled people by limits (1). Keller proves inner power (1). The world 'receives' her message (1). Equal respect reduces inequality (1). The poem urges inclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Vivid rhetoric in para 10 (1). Imagery of creeping germs (1). Short exchanges in the hall (1). Action verbs in the chase (1). A comic final explanation (1).	2+2+1

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ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapters 9–12: **The Boy Who Broke the Bank, The Visitor (from The Book Thief), Helen Keller (poem) - Langston Hughes, The Stolen Bacillus** | Class 8 English_Gulmohar | Maximum Marks: 50

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 15 × 1 = 15

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(c)** strength needs no ornament	Compactness reflects power.
2	**(c)** It does not affect the main chase but drives comedy	Her chase adds humour and brings the husband home.
3	**(d)** "We want it now!" chanted the people.	Speech marks enclose the words with the exclamation inside.
4	**(b)** By the time Rosa opened the door, Papa had warned Max.	The earlier action takes past perfect.
5	**(d)** beauty is only outward	Challenges looks-based judgement.
6	**(b)** Fear based on false belief can be comic and foolish	The story's moral.
7	**(c)** stubborn about a belief without proof	They persisted without facts.
8	**(a)** contrast the calm sky with Liesel's inner turmoil	Irony of nature's calm.
9	**(c)** an active, personal achievement	She found it herself.
10	**(c)** containing the germ before it spreads	Glossary: contain the disease.
11	**(c)** human gullibility and love of gossip	The target is the town's readiness to believe.
12	**(a)** He was ready to defend himself but felt guilty about it	He says he would not have used them.
13	**(a)** people with sight who may lack insight	It implies ordinary perception.
14	**(a)** belief that his plan was simple and grand	The scheme seemed easy and unique.
15	**(c)** were	Plural subject nearest the verb, past tense.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 5 × 2 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
16	Fewer words give each one weight (1) and a sharp end line lingers in memory (1).	1+1
17	He experiments on animals with new bacteria (1). He admits that, like a fool, he told the visitor it was Asiatic cholera, which is careless (1).	1+1
18	It makes his panic and speed funnier (1) because we expect an old gentleman to be calm (1).	1+1
19	It lets us hear her mind directly (1). It shows her racing panic and quick decisions (1).	1+1
20	Dark and light stand for hardship and hope (1); symbols let a few words convey a whole life (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 5 × 3 = 15

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
21	Keller's light becomes the world's gain (1). She led the cause of disabled people (1). Inner strength thus serves society (1).	1+1+1
22	He thanks the host again and again (1). He is leaving with the tube (1). The politeness covers an act of theft (1).	1+1+1
23	It ends on Nathu's innocent thought (1). The unfinished sentence leaves the reader to smile (1). It confirms the irony and the title (1).	1+1+1
24	Papa steadies the family (1). Rosa's sharpness is a mask for fear and also helps the act (1). Both are needed, so partly agree (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Short lines slow the reader (1). Pauses place stress on key words (1). Steady rhythm suits a quiet tribute (1).	1+1+1
25	Each character acts on a wrong belief (1). Anarchist believes he has cholera (1). Minnie believes her husband is mad, while the scientist ends up amused (1).	1+1+1
	OR: 'Mrs Prakash laughed, Well, tell him to come and see me when he's free' (1). Nathu's 'increase of work' complaint at the riot's aftermath (1). The mild tone of each makes the situation funnier (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers

2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
26	(a) People who like trouble (1). (b) For excitement, as they had nothing to lose (1). (c) 'Tried to calm' shows he was a peacemaker (1). (d) Dry, humorous (1). (e) Crowds attract those who add to the noise and damage (1).	2+2+1
	OR: World sees: a cheerful family and a football girl (1). Truth: a Jewish man hides in the basement (1). Outwardly: scolding and jokes (1). Inwardly: fear and prayer (1). The contrast is the source of suspense (1).	2+2+1
27	Light: hope and insight (1+1). Loveliness: inner beauty (1+1). The two together form her dower, which she shares with the world (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Plot and theme (1). Characters (1). Irony and humour (1). Language and tone (1). Personal response (1).	2+2+1

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